

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Divorce: Why Does It Happen?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	In the 1990s, _____ of marriages in Europe and America ended in divorce.
2	Since then, divorce rates in the West have shown a _____, while the number of divorces elsewhere has risen.
3	Marrying _____ may increase the chance of growing apart later.
4	In one marriage, the wife began with _____, while her husband was highly educated.
5	Later, she wanted to stop being a _____ and return to education.
6	The resulting change in their situation became _____ for the couple.
7	More generally, partners' life _____ may change over time.
8	Some people remain in marriages that no longer work for _____ reasons.
9	In China, a _____ waiting period was introduced for couples seeking separation.
10	The presenter says a marriage may be saved if partners communicate _____, possibly with professional help.

11 **What contrast in divorce trends is described?**

- A Rates have stabilised in both the West and other regions.
- B Rates are increasing at similar speeds across the world.
- C Rates have slowed in the West but are rising elsewhere.
- D Rates have fallen outside the West but risen within it.

12 **Which pair of circumstances is identified as a common reason for partners to drift apart?**

- A Marrying early and having different backgrounds or interests.
- B Marrying late and having different levels of income.
- C Having children early and receiving different education.
- D Having different careers and living in different countries.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What does the account of the marriage's early years show?**
- A Both partners first wanted to return to education.
 - B The couple had similar educational opportunities.
 - C Their differences immediately made the marriage fail.
 - D Their differences did not prevent an initially good relationship.
- 14 **Why did the woman's return to school become a problem for the marriage?**
- A It forced her husband to give up his own education.
 - B It changed a family arrangement that had worked before.
 - C It made her decide that no couple should have children.
 - D It followed a period when the relationship had already ended.
- 15 **How did the couple's outlook change over time?**
- A They came to agree more strongly on their future.
 - B They developed different ideas about what they wanted.
 - C They returned to the same plans they had at first.
 - D They stopped caring about education altogether.
- 16 **What attitude does the presenter show toward people who remain in marriages that no longer work?**
- A She blames them for failing to adapt.
 - B She doubts that such situations exist.
 - C She believes leaving is always simple.
 - D She regrets that some feel unable to leave.
- 17 **How does the counsellor view a compulsory waiting period when the relationship itself stays the same?**
- A It is unlikely by itself to restore the couple's wish to stay together.
 - B It is likely to restore the couple's wish to stay together immediately.
 - C It gives couples the communication training they need.
 - D It removes the need for any change between the partners.
- 18 **What policy direction follows most closely from the counsellor's comments?**
- A Governments should require couples to wait for much longer.
 - B Governments should decide which marriages can continue.
 - C Governments could help couples improve how they communicate.
 - D Governments could discourage couples from discussing problems.

- 19 **What feature of the Chinese cooling-off policy is presented as unusual?**
- A Courts choose which partners may separate.
 - B Government intervenes in couples' private lives.
 - C Counsellors determine the length of the wait.
 - D The rule applies only to unmarried couples.
- 20 **Which broader conclusion follows from the personal account and the counsellor's advice?**
- A Changes in people's lives can strain a marriage, and partners may need to change how they communicate.
 - B Once partners return to education, their marriage always ends.
 - C A compulsory wait will resolve differences created by changing circumstances.
 - D Financial support alone can repair every troubled marriage.